

PTAB Meeting Minutes: May 21, 2025

Present: Colleen O'Neill, Stacey Allott, Doug Haney, Jimmy Cunningham, Julianne Stemp, Ashley Garwood, Stephen Langdon, Ezra Schwartzberg, Mary Thill, Katrina Glynn (Village Employee), Aurora White (Village Trustee (remote)), Charlotte Lomino (public attendee), Owen Keil (public attendee), Adrienne Hayden (public attendee), Nick Friedman (public attendee)

1. Approve March Meeting Minutes: Motion by Stacey Allott, Second by Julianne Stemp

2. New Business:

- **Accessibility Assessment:**

- Nick Friedman of Accessible Adirondack Tourism discussed his assessment plans for parks in the Village, except Baldwin and Garwood as those are already receiving accessibility improvements through earlier projects and other grants. Nick mentioned an event at Lake Colby on Saturday at 9:15 a.m. re: accessibility all are welcome to attend.
- Village budget granted for 2 pieces of accessible equipment at Lake Colby; a mat and a wheelchair with floating tires. We need accessible bathrooms as well, and until building renovations are complete consider temporary/rental accessible toilets. A comprehensive long-term discussion about accessibility at Lake Colby and throughout the Village is required; Katrina will bring this up at Village Board Meeting in June.

- **Public Comment:**

- Mt. Pisgah Bike Trails: Owen Keil and Adrienne Hayden. Wondering about the trail layout and flagging. Adrienne points out that very difficult trails are important to match the skills and growth of mountain bikers and encourage tourism. They were invited by Doug Haney to attend a future Saranac Lake Trail Committee meeting which will discuss the trail plans in depth. Discussion about the capacity of Pisgah to support more mountain biking use, shuttles and lifts like other bike friendly towns.

3. Unfinished Business:

- **Initiative and Park Updates**

- **Baldwin:** Crosswalk to Baldwin Park is likely and a traffic light at Will Rogers/Lake Flower Avenue. Meeting with Labella about a timber frame pavilion, interpretive signs (braille and QR code), trees and shrubs. There will be two handicap parking spots closest to the adaptive boat launch. Concept plan will then go to DOT.

- **Boothe River Park:** FERC licensing passed through Gomez and Sullivan, easements are ongoing and Katrina to follow up with DOT. Need to raise funds for further work. Considering hiring a grant writer. Fundraiser on 5/17 went well, there is another fundraiser Duck Race on June 22 find out more at <https://bootheriverpark.com/events>. Plan to apply for NBRC and other grants in Fall, or a CFA grant. Riverwalk will get new directional and interpretive signage and kiosks, maps, and promotional brochures. Kelly Brunette is leading this initiative.
- **Community Bike Ride:** Doug and Julianne working with Bayle and ROOST on marketing materials.
- **Garwood:** Grant is in; a new Municipal Park and Recreation (MPR) grant we should hear back by end of Summer.
- **Lake Colby:** Ashley, Steve and Mary are collaborating on general improvements needed and a focus on accessibility.
- **Mt. Pisgah:** NBRC grant in and now waiting to hear back. Discussion about capacity of the infrastructure for making snow and understanding the implications of proper equipment on personnel budgets; it's not sustainable the way it is now with equipment and personnel. Many equipment breakdowns, excessive snowmaking hours due to pump equipment, relying on volunteers, tubing lift issues, snowcat broke down. Doug asked PTAB to provide feedback on the draft bike trail plan he sent via email today.
- **Park Maintenance Checklist:** Everyone completed their park reviews, so Colleen will submit them to the Village for DPW to add to their schedule.
- **Pollinator Habitats and Climate Planning:** Steve is in communication with Garrett Marino who leads the Village Climate Smart Task Force. Climate Task Force is planning a Pollinator Festival downtown this Summer. Saranac Lake aims to get a 'Monarch Friendly Village' designation.
- **Riverside Park Bandshell:** Currently repairing stairs and plans to paint.
- **Rail Trail Connections and Crossings:** Construction: Temporary detour through early June for culvert Fowler's Crossing and NCCC and Ray Brook Road to Fowler's Crossing 5/19-23. For Village crossings, striping, bollard, speed radar sign installed. Inquired about DOT and Village Committee/working group mentioned in Board Meeting Minutes in the past; PTAB would like to keep our recommendations on their radar, especially speed limit at Fowler's Crossing, asking for their data, sharing our DEC data. Colleen to follow up with Kelly Brunette re: DOT Committee. Charlotte Lomino mentioned her proposed letter to DOT and asked PTAB to review and consider it with DOT talks, she can also share traffic count data with us.
- **Recycling Program:** Doug to follow-up with Aurora re: a meeting to discuss further.
- **Sidewalk Assessments:** Submitted to Village on 5/5.
- **Ward Plumadore:** Mountainscape is moving forward and artist is aiming to have it done before July 4. Village will dig the trench for electrical. Public mentioned that park sign should appear as two last names that founded the park; Red Plumadore and Danny Ward; not the first and last name how it appears now Ward (smaller text) Plumadore (large text). PTAB voted on firetower height for the shorter 40 foot vs. 50 foot; enables more usage for all ages, fits in better with surroundings, has similar great view, saves costs.

4. Other:

- **Capital Improvement Plan:** Open house on 5/29 at 5:30-7:30 p.m. at Town Hall.

5. **Adjourn** at 7:35 p.m.: Motion by Ashley Garwood, Second by Doug Haney